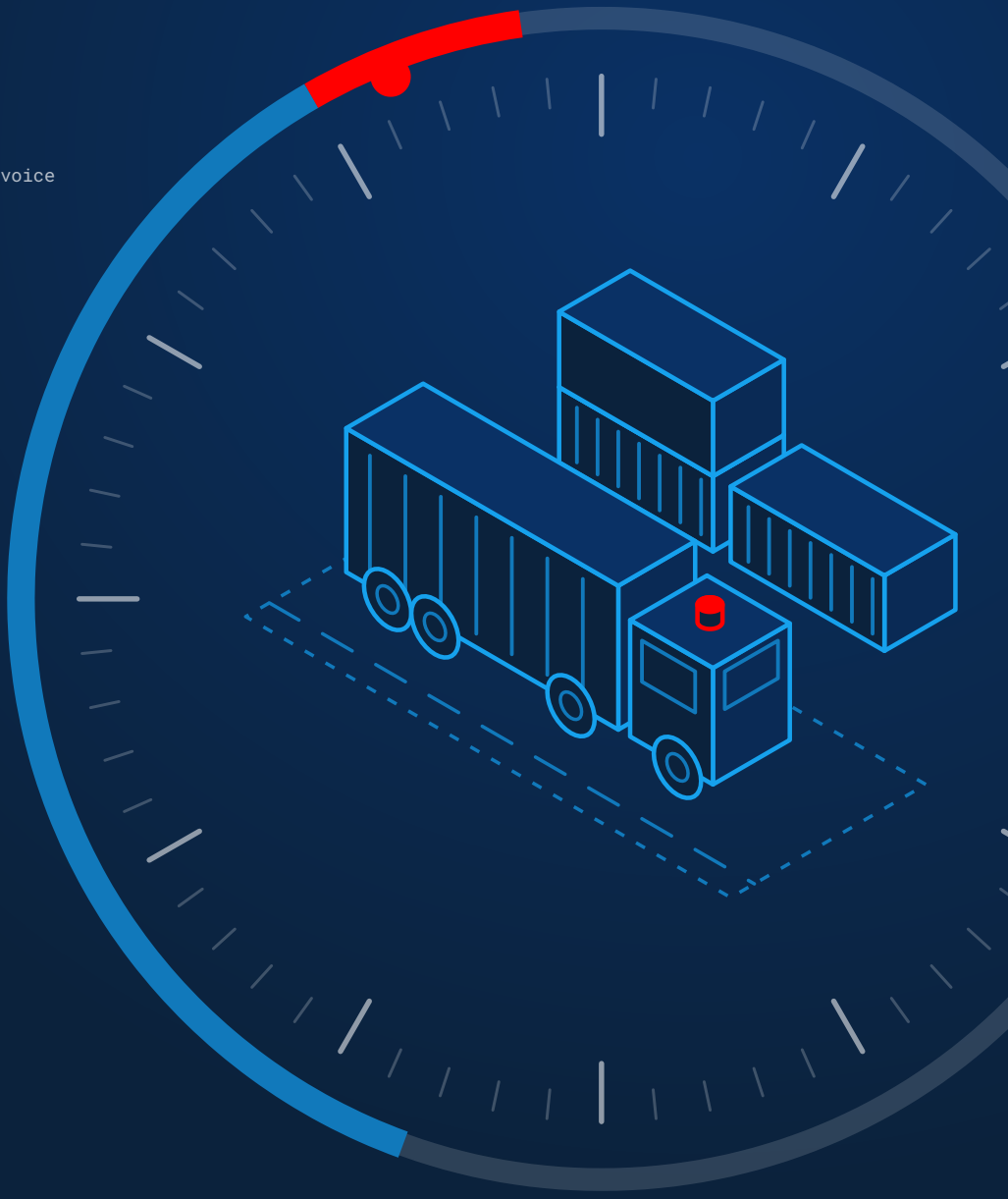
CRISIS PLAYBOOK · NO. 04

- T+00:00 Incident declared
- T+00:02 Alert sent · push, SMS, voice
- T+01:30 Escalated · no response
- T+04:10 Team acknowledged



TRANSPORT AND LOGISTICS

# Keep it moving.

Hub and depot incidents, storms, IT and cyber outages, failed suppliers and drivers on their own at 3am. How to reroute, inform and protect people in the first hour, and what to fix before the next one.

T+00:00 · T+00:05 · T+00:15 · T+01:00 · T+04:00

INSIDE

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How to keep people, goods and passengers moving, and staff safe, when a hub goes dark or a driver stops answering.

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FOREWORD

# In transport, nobody fails alone. One fault becomes everyone's problem within the hour.

On 21 March 2025 Heathrow closed for most of a day after a fire at the North Hyde substation in west London. More than 270,000 passenger journeys were disrupted.[1] The official review found that losing one of the airport's three supply points cut power to some operationally critical systems, and that reconfiguring the airport's network to run on the other two would take an estimated 10 to 12 hours.[2]

Six months later a ransomware attack on a check-in system supplier forced staff at Heathrow, Brussels and Berlin back to handwritten boarding passes.[3] A cyber attack halted production at Jaguar Land Rover for five weeks and left its suppliers waiting for orders and payments.[4,5] And on 8 September 2026 a software defect in the UK's air traffic system delayed, cancelled or diverted more than 2,000 flights.[6]

This playbook is for the people who hold it together when that happens, wherever they operate: operations, resilience, security, safety and communications leaders in airports, ports, rail, bus and coach, freight and logistics. It sets out how to grade and escalate an incident, what to do in the first hour, how to keep drivers and lone workers safe and how to bring contractors and partners into one response. Its Practical toolkit gives you seven tools to use, from the Roles and responsibilities matrix to the Post-incident review template. The companion intelligence report sets out the evidence in full.

**The Crises Control team**
Crises Control

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

# Keep people safe, keep partners informed and keep a record of every decision.

## 01 · THE OPERATIONAL CHALLENGE

- Networks run on power, systems, routes and suppliers you do not own, so one failure lands on many sites at once.
- Drivers, crews and lone workers are spread out, often at night, and are hard to reach or account for quickly.
- Partners, customers and passengers expect clear updates while the cause and restoration time are still unknown.

## 02 · INCIDENTS AND RISKS TO PREPARE FOR

- Power loss or fire at a hub, depot, port, terminal or control room.
- An IT, cyber or supplier failure that stops planning, dispatch, check-in or signalling.
- Severe weather closing routes while vehicles, crews and passengers are already on the move.
- A driver or lone worker who misses a check-in and cannot be reached.

## 03 · KEY RECOMMENDATIONS

- Map single points of failure and test how long each backup really lasts.
- Give every key decision maker two independent contact routes, with escalation when nobody acknowledges.
- Run a missed check-in procedure on every shift, with times and owners agreed in advance.
- Agree with partners and suppliers who tells whom, by what route and how fast.
- Know the reporting duties in each country you operate in, and rehearse the first hour.

## 04 · WHAT EFFECTIVE COORDINATION LOOKS LIKE

- One severity scale and one incident log used by sites, network control and partners.
- Every driver and site gets one instruction, and acknowledgements show who has not.
- Named people decide to hold, divert or cancel, and the reasons are recorded.
- Customers and passengers hear from you first, with a time for the next update.

## 05 · HOW CRISES CONTROL SUPPORTS THE RESPONSE

**Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end.**

Crises Control is an Operational Incident Coordination Platform: SOS and Ping alerts with acknowledgement tracking, response plans with owned tasks, a live Control Centre view and timestamped records.

Escalation rules, groups by site or route and message templates are configured to match your network. Incidents are raised by people or, where an integration is configured, by connected systems.

INTRODUCTION

# Three things keep a network moving on a bad day.

Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end, from the first report to the review. In transport and logistics, the operators that recover fastest know where the network is fragile, who must hear first and how to reach every person in it.

### Know your single points of failure

One power intake, one planning system, one supplier or one control room can stop a whole network. Find them, test the fallback and know how long it lasts.

### Reach everyone, by more than one route

Staff, drivers, contractors, partners, customers and passengers each need the right message, fast, with a record of who has acknowledged and who has not.

### People before payload

Every decision starts with the safety of passengers, crews, drivers and lone workers. Freight can wait in a yard. A driver who has stopped answering cannot.

# Disruption travels faster than freight.

A fault at one hub, airport or control room reaches drivers, partners and passengers within minutes. Sending the alert is the easy part. The first hour decides whether people get one clear instruction, act on it and are followed up, or work it out for themselves.

PART 01

# Before it hits.

Find where your network is fragile, know the rules that apply where you operate and fix the gaps the recent reviews exposed.

01 Why transport incidents spread

02 Six disruptions, first moves

03 Resilience duties by region

04 Incident reporting by region

05 Readiness in six steps

BEFORE IT HITS

# Your network is only as strong as the parts you do not own

> **Incident management in this sector is mostly about the space between organisations.**

A transport or logistics operation is a chain of dependencies. Power comes from a network operator. Planning, booking and check-in run on systems built by suppliers. Track, airspace, roads and berths belong to someone else. Drivers, handlers and engineers are often contractors or agency staff. When one link fails, the effect lands somewhere else: at a gate, a loading bay, a platform or a lay-by.

Recent reviews in the UK make the point clearly. At Heathrow, the risk that one supply point might fail was understood at a technical level but less well known outside the technical team.[7] After the 2023 failure of the UK's flight planning system, several airlines and airports first heard about it from the media.[8] In September 2025, airports that had done nothing wrong lost their check-in desks because a supplier was attacked.[3]

So incident management in this sector is mostly about the space between organisations. Who tells the partner sites? Who tells the drivers already on the road? Who decides to divert, and who tells the customer whose delivery will now be late? Who checks that the contractor on the night shift is out of the building?

That means three things have to be settled before anything happens. A severity scale that every site and partner understands. A map of who must be told, in what order, by what route. And a clear way to account for people, from passengers in a terminal to a driver parked alone at a closed depot.

None of this is exotic. Much of it is in the recommendations of the reviews that followed Heathrow and the air traffic failures: a second way to reach key people, earlier warnings to partners and a standard set of information for passengers.[1,9] The lessons apply in any country. The work is in making them true across sites, shifts and suppliers before the next incident, not during it.

SIX DISRUPTIONS

# Six disruptions and the first moves that matter

What to do in the first fifteen minutes, before the cause is clear.

| DISRUPTION | FIRST OPERATIONAL MOVE | FIRST PEOPLE AND COMMUNICATION MOVE |
|---|---|---|
| **Hub, depot, port or airport incident** | Make the site safe. Stop inbound movements. Decide hold, divert or close. | Account for staff, contractors and visiting drivers. Tell partner sites and drivers on the road. |
| **Power loss** | Confirm what is on backup and how long it will last. Ask the network operator for an estimate.[2] | Alert the incident team by two routes. Warn customers that services from the site may stop. |
| **Severe weather** | Act on official weather warnings before they peak: pre-position, cancel early, protect exposed routes. | Tell drivers and crews where to stop safely. Tell passengers and customers early, with what to do. |
| **IT or cyber outage** | Switch to manual or offline procedures. Isolate if attack is suspected. Keep evidence. | Tell sites what still works and what not to touch. Check the reporting clock that applies. |
| **Supplier or system failure** | Ask the supplier for scope and a time. Move to the fallback you agreed in advance.[3] | Tell affected partners and customers once, plainly, with the next update time. |
| **Driver or lone worker not responding** | Follow the missed check-in procedure at once. Do not wait for the end of the shift. | Call, then locate, then send help. Tell the family only through the agreed route. |

RESILIENCE DUTIES

# Who has duties when the network stops

Emergency and resilience rules differ by country. These are examples to check, not a full list. Each card says who it applies to and its status.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED KINGDOM

Transport companies are category 2 responders under the Civil Contingencies Act 2004: "co-operating bodies" with a lesser set of duties, centred on co-operating and sharing information with other responders through local resilience forums.[10]

IN PRACTICE Know your local resilience forum contacts and what information you would share in the first hour.

REGIONAL NOTE · EUROPEAN UNION

The CER Directive (EU) 2022/2557 covers air, rail, water, road and public transport. Member States had to identify critical entities by 17 July 2026. Those entities need a risk assessment, resilience and crisis measures, and must notify significant disruptions within 24 hours.[12]

IN PRACTICE Check whether your national authority has designated you, and when duties start.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED STATES

FMCSA rules (49 CFR 390.23) relax hours of service for carriers giving direct assistance in a declared emergency, for limited periods. A driver who says they need immediate rest must get at least 10 consecutive hours off duty before returning.[11]

IN PRACTICE Relief is not a reason to push tired drivers. Keep check-ins and fatigue checks running.

REGIONAL NOTE · MIDDLE EAST (UAE)

NCEMA's national business continuity standard, AE/SCNS/NCEMA 7000:2021, states that it applies to all UAE entities. Its response structure must cover command and control, immediate response and communication during disruptions, with exercises at planned intervals.[13]

IN PRACTICE Map your plan to its response structure and keep post-exercise reports.

A summary for orientation, not legal advice. Requirements depend on sector, size, licence and jurisdiction, and change over time. Confirm the current text with your legal and compliance teams.

INCIDENT REPORTING

# Reporting a cyber or system incident: the clock starts early

Most transport regimes set short deadlines for cyber and network incidents. Know which apply to you before you need them.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED KINGDOM

Operators of essential transport services under the NIS Regulations 2018 must notify their competent authority within 72 hours of becoming aware of a significant incident.[14] The Cyber Security and Resilience Bill proposes an initial notice within 24 hours, then a full report.[15]

IN PRACTICE The Bill is a proposal: track its progress and plan for the shorter clock.

REGIONAL NOTE · UNITED STATES

TSA security directives 1580-21-01E and 1582-21-01E (effective 16 January 2026 to 15 January 2027) apply to designated freight rail, passenger rail and rail transit operators. They require reporting cyber incidents to CISA within 72 hours, a 24/7 cybersecurity coordinator and an annually exercised incident response plan.[16]

IN PRACTICE Directives are renewed and revised: check the current version.

REGIONAL NOTE · EUROPEAN UNION

NIS2, Directive (EU) 2022/2555, covers air, rail, water and road transport entities. Significant incidents need an early warning within 24 hours, a notification within 72 hours and a final report within one month. National rules apply from 18 October 2024.[17]

IN PRACTICE Read your Member State's transposing law, which can add detail.

REGIONAL NOTE · MIDDLE EAST (SAUDI ARABIA)

The NCA Essential Cybersecurity Controls (ECC-2:2024) apply to government entities and to private entities owning, operating or hosting critical national infrastructure. They require incident response plans, escalation procedures, incident classification and reporting incidents to the NCA.[18]

IN PRACTICE Align your escalation workflow with the NCA reporting route.

A summary for orientation, not legal advice. Requirements depend on sector, size, licence and jurisdiction, and change over time. Confirm the current text with your legal and compliance teams.

READINESS

# Readiness in six steps

Each step comes from a lesson in a recent official review. Finish them before your next peak season.

## 01 Map your single points of failure

Power intakes, control rooms, planning and check-in systems, fuel and key suppliers. At Heathrow, losing one of three supply points cut power to critical systems.[2]

## 02 Test backup for duration, not just start-up

Find out how long each backup source lasts. Heathrow's review found nearly all emergency power on the affected supply would have run out before main power returned.[7]

## 03 Give every key person a second route

The Heathrow review recommended a second means of contact for significant incidents, in addition to the existing alert calls.[1]

## 04 Check on-call staff can actually act

In the 2023 UK air traffic failure an on-call engineer could not log in remotely and reached the control centre 3 hours 15 minutes after the failure began.[8]

## 05 Agree who tells partners, and how fast

After the same failure, several airlines and airports first heard of it from the media.[8]

## 06 Set weather triggers in advance

Decide which warnings cancel which services, who makes the early morning call and how drivers already out are told.

PART 02

# Incident scenarios.

How to grade an incident, the first hour at a hub that has gone dark, lane by lane, three scenarios to plan for and the actions board the morning after.

01 A transport severity ladder

02 The first hour, and lane by lane

03 Three scenarios: where they go wrong

04 Outstanding actions

SEVERITY

# A transport severity ladder for every site and partner

Grade early and regrade often. If in doubt, go one level higher and step down later.

SEV 1

## Critical

TRIGGERS

A hub, port, terminal or depot closed. Power, IT or a critical supplier lost across the network. Confirmed cyber attack on operations. A fatality, serious injury or missing driver. A red weather warning on key routes.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Crisis team, all affected site leads, safety, security, IT, communications, legal and key partners.

`Voice · SMS · push · team call in 15 min`

SEV 2

## Major

TRIGGERS

One site partly down. An amber warning across a region. A planning, booking or check-in system failing. A road collision with injury. A credible threat to a crew or driver.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Incident manager, site and regional leads, IT or engineering on call, communications on standby.

`SMS · push · escalate after 10 min`

SEV 3

## Moderate

TRIGGERS

A single depot or route affected. A breakdown in an unsafe place. A partner running late. A lone worker check-in missed by up to 30 minutes.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Site lead, transport planner or controller, service desk.

`Push · email`

SEV 4

## Minor

TRIGGERS

Short delays, a single device fault, a near miss or an abusive passenger without injury.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Site lead, recorded for trend reporting and the weekly review.

`App · email`

THE FIRST HOUR

# Thursday, 23:40: a substation fire cuts power to your main hub

Illustrative. The cause is not yours. The response is.

| CLOCK | ACTION | OWNER |
|---|---|---|
| T+00:00 | **Power lost at the hub**<br>Lights, sortation and yard systems stop. Backup starts, but not everything is on it. | HUB DUTY MANAGER |
| T+00:05 | **SEV 1 declared, log started**<br>The team is alerted by call and SMS. Anyone silent after five minutes is called again. | INCIDENT MANAGER |
| T+00:10 | **Account for everyone on site**<br>Roll call of staff, agency workers, contractors and visiting drivers. | SITE SAFETY LEAD |
| T+00:15 | **Stop inbound vehicles**<br>Drivers heading in stop at a safe place and acknowledge. Nobody arrives at a dark yard. | TRANSPORT PLANNER |
| T+00:30 | **Decide where the freight goes**<br>No restoration time yet. Divert trunks to hubs with confirmed capacity. | OPERATIONS DIRECTOR |
| T+00:45 | **Tell customers before they ask**<br>Key customers hear what is affected and when the next update is. | CUSTOMER SERVICE · COMMS |
| T+01:00 | **First crisis team review**<br>People, freight, drivers' hours and the morning plan. | INCIDENT MANAGER |

LANE BY LANE

# The hub power loss, lane by lane

The same illustrative incident, showing who acts, who decides, where it goes wrong and how each step is watched.

| | T+00:00 | T+00:05 | T+00:15 | T+00:30 | T+00:45 | T+01:00 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Drivers** | ! Trunks still heading for a dark yard | Stop alert: park safely, reply 1 | ! Three drivers silent after ten minutes | Replies and locations tracked | Rerouted to receiving hubs | Drivers' hours checked before onward legs |
| **Hub and depots** | ! Backup covers only some systems | Duty manager raises the alarm, with location where available | Roll call: staff, agency, visiting drivers | ! Agency workers missing from the list | Roll call confirmed to incident manager | |
| **Network control** | | ◆ SEV 1 declared, log started | Silent leads called by second route | ◆ Operations director: divert to hubs with capacity | Missed check-ins escalated to duty manager | ◆ First review: people, freight, morning plan |
| **Suppliers and partners** | | Network operator asked for an estimate | ! No restoration time; plan for hours | Receiving hubs and hauliers told | Partners acknowledge; same update clock | |
| **Customers and passengers** | | | | ! Calls start before any message is sent | Key customers told impact and next update | Next update sent at the promised time |

Action · Decision · Where it goes wrong · Monitored

**Where it goes wrong:** drivers who never got the stop message, people missing from the roll call and customers who hear nothing. **Who decides:** the incident manager declares and grades; the operations director decides where freight goes. **How it is monitored:** network control watches acknowledgements, check-ins and the time of the next update, and chases anything silent.

SCENARIOS

# Three illustrative scenarios: where they go wrong and who decides

REGIONAL BUS AND COACH OPERATOR

## A red wind warning on a weekday morning

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

Deciding route by route at 05:00, with drivers already out and passengers waiting at stops.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Hourly driver check-ins and a live list of routes running, held or cancelled.

WHO DECIDES

The operations director at a 04:30 call, on triggers agreed in advance.

REHEARSE

Walk through the 04:30 decision call with depot leads.

PARCEL AND FREIGHT NETWORK

## The planning system supplier is hit by ransomware

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

Waiting for the supplier before telling sites and customers anything.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Depot acknowledgements, loads dispatched against plan and a supplier update on a fixed clock.

WHO DECIDES

The incident manager declares; the operations director moves hubs to the offline route pack.

REHEARSE

Run one hub for two hours without the planning system.

AIRPORT GROUND HANDLER

## Check-in and bag drop go down at 06:00

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

Each airline saying something different at its own desks as queues build.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Queue times, desks open on manual kits and one agreed passenger message.

WHO DECIDES

The terminal duty manager, with airline station managers, on one manual check-in plan.

REHEARSE

A 30-minute manual check-in drill with airline partners.

OUTSTANDING ACTIONS

# Outstanding actions, the morning after

Illustrative, following the hub power loss. The incident manager reviews this board at every update; every action has an owner, a due time and a way to check it is done.

| ACTION | OWNER | DUE | STATUS | HOW IT IS CHECKED |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Account for the agency worker missing from the roll call** | Depot lead | 00:20 | DONE | Agency confirmation recorded in the log |
| **Confirm drivers held overnight are rested and fit to drive** | Network control | 05:00 | DONE | Check-in log and drivers' hours records |
| **Get a written restoration estimate from the network operator** | Engineering lead | 06:00 | BLOCKED | Estimate logged; chased every hour |
| **Send customers the 07:00 update** | Comms and customer service | 07:00 | OVERDUE | Sent time compared with promised time |
| **Clear diverted freight at receiving hubs** | Operations director | Day 2 | IN PROGRESS | Volumes reported at each review |
| **Test how long backup power lasts before reopening** | Engineering lead | Day 2 | OPEN | Test result signed off by the site lead |
| **Call the three drivers who missed check-ins** | Health and safety lead | Day 2 | OPEN | Welfare call recorded for each driver |
| **Decide whether a regulator notification is needed** | Incident manager, with legal | Per regime | IN PROGRESS | Decision, deadline and reasons recorded |
| **Book the post-incident review with partners** | Incident manager | Day 5 | OPEN | Each partner has accepted |

> Anything overdue or blocked goes to the top of the next crisis team review, with one named person to unblock it.

PART 03

# Respond and recover.

Keeping drivers and lone workers safe, rerouting, bringing partners into one response and a dated plan with owners.

01 Missed check-ins and the driver log

02 Rerouting and keeping people informed

03 Contractors, partners and the notification log

04 This week, this month, this quarter

MISSED CHECK-INS

# When a driver or lone worker stops answering

An extra escalation for people working alone. These times are illustrative: set them by risk and test them on night shifts.

| | TRIGGER | WHO IS ALERTED | WHO DECIDES |
|---|---|---|---|
| LEVEL 1<br>**T+0 Missed check-in** | A driver or lone worker misses a scheduled check-in. The check-in log flags it to the controller; nobody relies on memory. | Network controller. The driver by app and SMS. | Network controller |

↓ ESCALATE IF THERE IS NO REPLY WITHIN 10 MINUTES

| | TRIGGER | WHO IS ALERTED | WHO DECIDES |
|---|---|---|---|
| LEVEL 2<br>**T+10 Contact** | No reply to the app or SMS. | The controller calls the driver, then the vehicle or site phone, then any colleague nearby. | Network controller |

↓ ESCALATE IF THERE IS STILL NO CONTACT BY T+20

| | TRIGGER | WHO IS ALERTED | WHO DECIDES |
|---|---|---|---|
| LEVEL 3<br>**T+20 Locate** | Still no contact. Record it in the check-in log as unresolved. | Duty manager and depot lead. Last known location and telematics checked. | Duty manager |

↓ ESCALATE IF THERE IS STILL NO CONTACT BY T+30, OR ANY SIGN OF DANGER

| | TRIGGER | WHO IS ALERTED | WHO DECIDES |
|---|---|---|---|
| LEVEL 4<br>**T+30 Send help** | No contact, or any sign of danger at any point. Declare SEV 2, or SEV 1 if the driver is confirmed missing or hurt. | Emergency services where there is any risk to life. Incident manager and health and safety lead. Family only through the agreed route. | Duty manager, with the incident manager |

Call the emergency services at once if there is any sign of danger; do not wait for the next level. Shorten the times for higher risk work such as night parking or remote sites. **United Kingdom:** HSE guidance says employers must monitor lone workers, keep in touch with them and test emergency procedures regularly.[19]

DRIVER CHECK-IN LOG

# Driver and lone worker check-in log

One line per scheduled check-in. Network control keeps it on every night shift; a blank in the actual time column is a live escalation.

| DRIVER AND VEHICLE | ROUTE OR LOCATION | DUE | ACTUAL | STATUS CODE | IF MISSED: ACTION AND TIME | CONTROLLER |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Driver 14 · Vehicle 207* | *Services, junction 5 (planned rest)* | *02:00* | *02:04* | *OK, parked* | *None* | *Initials* |
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Agree the rhythm before the shift: planned route, check-in times and a status code. Higher risk work, such as night parking or remote sites, gets shorter intervals. Record the outcome of every missed check-in, check on the person the next day and keep the log for the review.

REROUTING AND INFORMATION

# Rerouting and keeping people informed

The review of the 2023 UK air traffic failure asked airlines and airports to develop a standard suite of passenger information for major incidents.[9] The same discipline works for freight customers.

### Decide the route, then say it once

Agree the diversion or alternative with the receiving site before announcing it. One instruction, one owner, one time stamp, sent to every site and driver affected.

### Tell people what to do

Lead with the action: do not travel, rebook, collect from another depot, expect delivery tomorrow. Then explain the cause, if you know it.

### Set the next update and keep it

Give a time for the next update, even if there will be nothing new. Silence is when rumours start and phone lines jam.

### Reach people without data

Not everyone has the app. Use SMS, station and terminal staff, partner desks and recorded phone lines alongside the website.

# 01

# Bring contractors and partners into one response

Most transport incidents involve people you do not employ: network operators, system suppliers, hauliers, handlers, security and cleaning contractors, neighbouring sites. They need to hear early and act on the same facts.

### KNOW WHO THEY ARE

Every partner that can stop your operation, or be stopped by it, with a 24-hour contact and a named owner.

### TELL THEM FIRST

Partners should hear from you, not the news. Agree in contracts how fast you tell each other.

### SHARE ONE CLOCK

Key partners join the incident call, with the same severity scale and update times.

### PLAN FOR THEIR FAILURE

JLR set up early payment financing for suppliers critical to its restart.[5] Ask what yours would need.

OWNER

**Head of operations, with procurement**

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

PARTNER NOTIFICATION LOG

# Partner and supplier notification log

Who must hear from you, who told them, when, and whether they acknowledged. Fill in the first three columns now, not during an incident.

| PARTNER OR SUPPLIER | WHAT THEY DO FOR US | 24-HOUR CONTACT | TOLD AT | TOLD BY | ACKNOWLEDGED | NEXT UPDATE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Planning system supplier* | *Route planning and labels* | *24-hour service desk* | *22:12* | *Network control* | *22:15, by phone* | *23:00* |
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After the 2023 UK air traffic failure, several airlines and airports first heard about it from the media.[8] A partner that is not on this log will not be told.

YOUR PLAN

# This week, this month, this quarter

Owners are suggestions. Adjust them to your structure, and date every action.

| WHEN | ACTIONS | OWNER |
|---|---|---|
| **This week** | Publish the severity ladder, Escalation workflow, Roles and responsibilities matrix and Communication templates to every site. Confirm a second contact route for every key person. | Head of resilience |
| **This week** | Put the driver check-in log and missed check-in escalation live on every night shift, and test it. | Head of health and safety |
| **This month** | Map single points of failure: power, control rooms, systems and suppliers. Test how long each backup lasts. | Engineering and IT leads |
| **This month** | Agree partner notification routes and 24-hour contacts with your top 20 suppliers and partners. | Head of operations, with procurement |
| **This quarter** | Run the Tabletop exercise in this playbook with partners, then a hub power loss at night. Track every fix. | Operations director |
| **This quarter** | Check reporting duties and deadlines in each country you operate in. Report gaps and dated fixes to the board. | Chief operating officer, with legal |

PRACTICAL TOOLKIT

# Seven tools for your next incident

The same seven tools appear in every Crises Control playbook, with examples for your industry. Copy them, adapt them and rehearse with them.

01 **Readiness assessment** 27
Score eight areas from 0 to 3 and find your weakest link.

02 **Roles and responsibilities matrix** 28
Who is responsible, accountable, consulted and informed for each activity.

03 **Incident decision log** 29
Record every material decision, who made it and why, as it happens.

04 **Escalation workflow** 30
Four levels, their triggers, who is alerted and who decides.

05 **Communication templates** 31
Ready-to-send messages for staff, customers, regulators, partners and media.

06 **Tabletop exercise** 32
A ready-to-run scenario with timed injects and questions for the room.

07 **Post-incident review template** 33
Eight prompts that turn an incident into lessons and owned actions.

> Every tool works on paper. In Crises Control the same roles, escalation rules, templates and logs can be set up in the platform, so they run during the incident and leave a record afterwards.

TOOLKIT 01 · READINESS ASSESSMENT

# How ready is your response?

Score each area from 0 (not in place) to 3 (fully in place) for your transport and logistics organisation, then add up the total.

| AREA | THE QUESTION | SCORE 0 TO 3 |
|---|---|---|
| 01 · ACTIVATION **Alert** | Can you reach the right people on more than one channel within minutes, day or night? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Drivers, depot staff, partners and contractors reached on several channels, at any hour. | 0 1 2 3 |
| 02 · ACTIVATION **Acknowledge** | Do you know who has seen the alert, and does silence trigger escalation by rule? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Acknowledgement and welfare checks for lone and remote workers, with escalation on silence. | 0 1 2 3 |
| 03 · COORDINATION **Escalate** | Are escalation paths set by role and time, not by whoever remembers who to call? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Escalation to duty managers and partner organisations runs by rule. | 0 1 2 3 |
| 04 · COORDINATION **Coordinate** | Is there one shared workspace and log for the incident, not scattered calls, chats and inboxes? GOOD LOOKS LIKE One incident log shared by operations, partners and customer communications. | 0 1 2 3 |
| 05 · EXECUTION **Execute** | Are your procedures turned into owned tasks with deadlines that someone can track? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Rerouting and recovery steps run as owned tasks across sites. | 0 1 2 3 |
| 06 · EXECUTION **See** | Can leaders see tasks, people, locations and blockers live, without having to ask? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A live view of sites, people, vehicles and outstanding actions. | 0 1 2 3 |
| 07 · ASSURANCE **Prove** | Could you produce a timestamped timeline for a regulator, insurer or inquiry within a day? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A timeline that supports regulators, insurers and the post-incident review. | 0 1 2 3 |
| 08 · ASSURANCE **Rehearse** | Do you exercise the whole response, not just the call tree, at least once a year? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Multi-partner exercises that include a second means of contact for key people. | 0 1 2 3 |

**0 to 8**
**Alerting only**
You can send messages. The response still depends on people and luck.

**9 to 16**
**Coordinating in parts**
Some steps work. Gaps appear at night, at scale or when systems fail.

**17 to 24**
**Coordinated and provable**
You can run the response and show exactly what happened.

TOOLKIT 02 · ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES MATRIX

# Who does what in a network incident

Illustrative roles for an operator with hubs, depots and drivers on the road. One person is accountable for each activity; agree the names and deputies before you need them.

| ACTIVITY | OPERATIONS DIRECTOR | INCIDENT MANAGER | NETWORK CONTROL | DEPOT OR HUB LEAD | HEALTH AND SAFETY | COMMS AND CUSTOMER SERVICE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Raise the first alert from site | · | I | I | A | I | · |
| Declare the incident and set severity | I | A | C | C | I | I |
| Account for everyone on site | · | I | · | A | R | · |
| Stop inbound vehicles and hold drivers safely | I | C | A | C | C | · |
| Run the missed check-in escalation | · | I | A | C | R | · |
| Decide to hold, divert or cancel | A | R | C | C | C | I |
| Tell partner sites, hauliers and suppliers | I | A | R | I | · | C |
| Tell customers and passengers | C | C | I | · | · | A |
| Speak to the media | A | C | · | · | C | R |
| Decide on regulator notification | A | R | · | · | C | C |
| Approve the return to normal operations | A | R | C | C | C | I |

R Responsible: does the work  A Accountable: owns the decision  C Consulted  I Informed

> Drivers and crews are not on this matrix because they never decide alone in a crisis: they act on one instruction from network control and acknowledge it. Make sure every driver knows who that is on each shift.

TOOLKIT 03 · INCIDENT DECISION LOG

# Every decision, who made it and why: the hub power loss

Illustrative example from the hub power loss in Part 02. Record decisions not to act as well, and the information you had at the time.

| TIME | DECISION | OPTIONS CONSIDERED | DECIDED BY | RATIONALE | EVIDENCE OR REFERENCE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *00:30* | *Divert inbound trunks from the dark hub to two receiving hubs* | *Hold all at hub; divert all; divert some and hold the rest* | *Operations director* | *No restoration time; backup covers only some systems; both hubs confirmed space* | *Network operator call 00:22; capacity confirmed 00:27* |
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Log decisions as they are made, not afterwards. Include decisions not to act. The log is the backbone of the timeline your board, auditors and regulators will ask for.

TOOLKIT 04 · ESCALATION WORKFLOW

# Who is told, and who decides, at each level

Severity says how bad it is. Escalation says who must act. Times are illustrative: set your own and test them out of hours.

| | TRIGGER | WHO IS ALERTED | WHO DECIDES |
|---|---|---|---|
| LEVEL 1 **Site or depot** | A local fault, a delayed vehicle, a breakdown in an unsafe place or a single missed check-in (SEV 3 to 4). | Depot or hub lead and the network controller on shift. | Depot or hub lead |
| ↓ ESCALATE IF IT IS NOT CONTAINED WITHIN 30 MINUTES, MORE THAN ONE SITE IS HIT OR ANYONE IS HURT | | | |
| LEVEL 2 **Network control** | More than one site or route affected, a planning or check-in system failing, or a key partner running late (SEV 2 to 3). | Network controller, incident manager, IT or engineering on call. | Incident manager |
| ↓ ESCALATE IF THERE IS NO RESTORATION TIME, CUSTOMERS OR PASSENGERS WILL BE AFFECTED, OR A DRIVER IS STILL NOT FOUND | | | |
| LEVEL 3 **Incident team** | A hub or terminal partly down, an amber warning across a region, a suspected cyber attack or a driver missing after the check-in procedure (SEV 2). | Incident team, health and safety, communications, IT and key partners. | Operations director: hold, divert or cancel |
| ↓ ESCALATE IF A SITE CLOSES, THERE IS SERIOUS INJURY, A CONFIRMED ATTACK OR MEDIA INTEREST | | | |
| LEVEL 4 **Crisis team** | A hub, port, terminal or depot closed, network-wide loss of power, IT or a critical supplier, a fatality or a red warning on key routes (SEV 1). | Executive team, legal, all site leads, partners and, where required, regulators. | Chief operating officer or accountable executive |

If a decision maker has not acknowledged within five minutes, alert their deputy by a second route and record it. The Heathrow review recommended a second means of contact for significant incidents.[1]

TOOLKIT 05 · COMMUNICATION TEMPLATES

# Six messages ready to send

Short, specific and honest. Fill the brackets, never guess the cause and always give the time of the next update.

### SMS · DRIVERS ON THE ROAD

141 chars

> SEV1: [Hub] has no power. Do not travel to site. Stop at [safe location] and reply 1 when parked. Next update 00:30. Call [number] if unsafe.

Ask for a reply so you know who has stopped.

### PUSH · HUB STAFF AND CONTRACTORS

> Power loss at [Hub]. Stop work safely and go to [assembly point] for a roll call. Do not restart equipment. Supervisors will brief you there.

### WEB BANNER · PASSENGERS

> Services from [terminal or station] are disrupted because of [a power failure]. Please do not travel to [location] today unless told your journey is running. Next update [10:00].

Lead with what to do. Add rebooking and refund links.

### EMAIL · CUSTOMERS, PARTNERS AND SUPPLIERS

> We are managing an incident at [site] affecting [services]. Freight is being diverted to [site]. Expect delays of [x hours]. We will update you at [time]. Contact [desk].

Partners should hear before the media does.

### EMAIL · REGULATOR

> Initial notification: [Organisation] is managing an incident affecting [service] since [time]. Impact: [summary]. Cause: under investigation. Contact: [name, number]. Full report to follow.

Deadlines differ by country and regime. See the regional notes in Part 01.

### HOLDING LINE · MEDIA

> We are aware of disruption affecting [services] and are working to restore them as quickly as possible. The safety of our passengers and colleagues comes first. We will share more information as soon as we can.

TOOLKIT 06 · TABLETOP EXERCISE

# Exercise: the planning system goes dark at night

Illustrative. A supplier cyber attack, run as a facilitated discussion. Release each inject only when the room has answered the last.

| DURATION | PARTICIPANTS | OBJECTIVE | FACILITATOR |
|---|---|---|---|
| Two and a half hours | Operations, network control, two depot leads, safety, comms, IT, a key haulier | Test the divert decision, missed check-ins and partner notice at night | Head of resilience, with an observer keeping the log |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 22:00 | INJECT 1<br>Route planning and label printing fail across the network. The supplier says it is investigating. | DISCUSS<br>Who declares, and at what severity? How are depots told? What do drivers already loaded do? |
| 22:20 | INJECT 2<br>The supplier confirms a suspected cyber attack and cannot give a restoration time. | DISCUSS<br>Do you cut any connections? Who decides to switch to the offline route pack? Which reporting clocks have started? |
| 23:10 | INJECT 3<br>A driver on a rural route misses two check-ins. The phone goes to voicemail. | DISCUSS<br>Who owns the escalation, and what times apply? At what point do you call the emergency services? |
| 00:30 | INJECT 4<br>A national news site reports the outage and names your company. | DISCUSS<br>Who speaks? Have customers and partners already heard from you? |
| 02:00 | INJECT 5<br>Two depots report the offline pack is out of date for key customers. | DISCUSS<br>Who decides which loads go first? How is that tracked and reported? |
| 05:30 | INJECT 6<br>The morning shift starts. The system is still down. | DISCUSS<br>What runs, what is cancelled, and who tells customers before 07:00? Which actions are still outstanding? |

> Afterwards, record the decisions in the Incident decision log, and the gaps and an owner for each fix in the Post-incident review template.

TOOLKIT 07 · POST-INCIDENT REVIEW TEMPLATE

# Post-incident review: what the system allowed to happen

Complete within two weeks, with partners in the room. Look for what the system allowed to happen, not for someone to blame.

INCIDENT _____ DATE _____ SEVERITY _____ REVIEW LEAD _____

### 01 What happened

A short timeline from first alert to stand-down. Which sites, routes, drivers and partners were affected?

### 02 People and welfare

Was everyone accounted for? How long did each missed check-in take to resolve?

### 03 Alerting and acknowledgement

How was it first reported? How long until the right people acknowledged, and who did not?

### 04 Decisions

Which decisions were made, by whom, when and on what information? Which waited too long?

### 05 Partners and suppliers

When was each partner told? Did any hear first from the media or a customer?

### 06 Customers and passengers

Were updates sent on time, in plain language and on more than one channel?

### 07 What worked, what did not

Backup duration, manual procedures, diversions and the incident log.

### 08 Actions

Each fix with an owner, a due date and how completion will be checked. Report to the board.

FOR LEADERS

# Questions for your leadership team

Ask them out loud. Vague answers are the finding.

## RESILIENCE

- ? If our main hub or terminal lost power tonight, how long would backup last, and what would stop first?
- ? Which single supplier or system could stop our whole operation, and what is the fallback?
- ? How quickly would every partner site and driver have one clear instruction?

## PEOPLE

- ? How do we know, minute by minute, that every lone worker and driver is safe?
- ? Could every key decision maker be reached at 1am if their phone was on silent?
- ? Do passengers and customers hear from us before they hear from the media?

CHECKLIST

# Are you ready to keep it moving?

Tick what is true today. Anything blank is your next action.

- [ ] **One severity ladder used by every site and key partner**
  With named owners and alert routes for each level.

- [ ] **Single points of failure mapped and backup duration known**
  Power, control rooms, systems and suppliers.

- [ ] **Two routes to every key decision maker**
  Tested out of hours, not only in office time.

- [ ] **Lone worker and driver check-ins live on every shift**
  With a set escalation for every missed check-in.

- [ ] **Communication templates approved and loaded**
  Drivers, staff, passengers, customers, regulators and media.

- [ ] **Partner contacts current and notification agreed**
  Including 24-hour numbers for critical suppliers.

- [ ] **Manual or offline procedures tested this quarter**
  Planning, check-in, dispatch and gate control.

- [ ] **Reporting duties known for every country you operate in**
  Who reports what, to whom, and by when.

GLOSSARY

# Words worth knowing

### Severity level
A shared grade (SEV 1 to SEV 4) that sets who is alerted, how fast and how often.

### Single point of failure
One component, site, system or supplier whose loss stops the whole operation.

### Supply point
A connection to the electricity network. Large sites may have several, each feeding different systems.

### Backup duration
How long a generator, battery or other fallback can run before it is exhausted.

### Lone worker
Anyone who works without close or direct supervision, such as a driver or night security officer.

### Welfare check
A planned contact to confirm a lone worker or driver is safe.

### Trunking
Moving freight in bulk between hubs, usually overnight.

### Manual fallback
A paper or offline way of doing a task when the system is down.

### NIS Regulations (UK)
The Network and Information Systems Regulations 2018, which set security and incident reporting duties for essential services, including transport.

### NIS2 (EU)
Directive (EU) 2022/2555 on cybersecurity, covering air, rail, water and road transport entities.

### CER Directive (EU)
Directive (EU) 2022/2557 on the resilience of critical entities, including in transport.

### Category 2 responder (UK)
A co-operating body under the Civil Contingencies Act 2004, such as a transport company.

### Holding line
A short, accurate statement used while facts are still being established.

### Incident manager
The person who runs the response, keeps the log and sets the rhythm of updates.

WHY COORDINATION, NOT JUST NOTIFICATION

# Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end.

When a substation fire cuts power to a hub at 23:40, the alert is minute one. Keeping goods and people moving depends on which drivers are safe, which partners know, what passengers or customers were told, and a clear record of who decided what.

WHERE INCIDENTS GO WRONG

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Fragmented information** | Different teams work from different information. |
| 02 | **Delayed decision making** | Leadership lacks visibility, so decisions wait. |
| 03 | **Uncoordinated response** | Several teams work independently on the same problem. |
| 04 | **Lack of visibility** | Critical actions become difficult to track. |
| 05 | **Lack of accountability** | Actions and decisions are poorly documented. |

THE WHOLE INCIDENT, IN ONE PLATFORM




Crises Control is an **Operational Incident Coordination Platform**. It helps organisations maintain operational control during incidents by combining alerting, coordination, execution, visibility and accountability in one platform.

THE PLATFORM

# One connected platform, from first alert to final report.

**Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end.** Crises Control helps organisations maintain operational control during incidents by combining alerting, coordination, execution, visibility and accountability in one platform. Each module of this incident management software does one job; the value comes from how they work together across the incident.

01

ESCALATE

**SOS**

Frontline staff raise an alert from the mobile app, with location where available.

02

START

**Ping**

Alerting and activation: reach people and collect acknowledgements and responses.

03

COORDINATE

**Incident Manager**

Authorised users activate the incident and its response plan, assign roles, control communication and keep the timeline.

04

EXECUTE

**Task Manager**

Assign actions, track completion and escalate what stalls, with clear accountability.

05

OPERATE

**Control Centre**

Real-time view of incidents, timelines, task status and assets.

06

PROVE

**Audit & Reporting**

Incident records, response analysis and task accountability, ready to report.

07

ASSIST

**CRAiG**

AI assistant (beta) that answers questions and summarises incident data. People make every decision.

THE OUTCOMES

### Alerting and activation

Reach the right people immediately.

### Operational coordination

Structure communication and response activities.

### Execution and visibility

Track tasks, responsibilities and progress.

### Proof and accountability

Create a complete, defensible operational record.

Most organisations start with the capability they need today, often alerting, and expand as their requirements mature. Highlighted modules are the ones this playbook draws on.

HOW THE MODULES WORK TOGETHER

# Crises Control in a transport incident, end to end

Crises Control is an Operational Incident Coordination Platform. Here is the hub power loss from this playbook, followed from the first alarm to the review.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | ESCALATE **SOS** | A depot duty manager or a driver on their own raises the alarm with SOS, sharing their location where available. |
| 02 | START **Ping** | Drivers, depot staff and partners are alerted by push, SMS and voice; anyone silent is chased and escalated under the rules you configure. |
| 03 | COORDINATE **Incident Manager** | The incident manager declares SEV 1, assigns network roles and keeps one communication log for the incident. |
| 04 | EXECUTE **Task Manager** | Roll call, missed check-in escalation, diversion and customer updates run as owned tasks with deadlines. |
| 05 | OPERATE **Control Centre** | Network control sees who has acknowledged the stop alert, task progress and locations where available, in one live view. |
| 06 | PROVE **Audit & Reporting** | A timestamped record of every alert, acknowledgement, logged decision and task supports the review, insurers and regulators. |
| 07 | ASSIST **CRAiG** | CRAiG answers questions such as who has not acknowledged and which tasks are open, from your own data and within each user's permissions. |

**COORDINATION**
Everyone works from the same incident, roles and log.

**VISIBILITY**
Leaders see progress without chasing for updates.

**EXECUTION**
Every action has an owner, a deadline and an escalation.

**ACCOUNTABILITY**
The record of what happened builds itself as you go.

WHAT IS STANDARD, WHAT IS CONFIGURED

# Clear about what the platform does.

Some capabilities work as standard. Others depend on how your team sets up plans, groups and rules, or on connecting your own systems. Your demonstration and implementation plan confirm what applies to you.

## STANDARD

Included in how each module works.

- SOS press-and-hold alert from the mobile app, raising an incident and sharing location where available
- Ping alerts by push, SMS, voice, email and desktop, with one-tap acknowledgement
- Incident Manager workspace, roles and a single communication log
- Task Manager tasks with owners and deadlines when a plan is activated
- Control Centre live view of status, acknowledgements, tasks and locations
- Audit & Reporting: timestamped records, exportable as PDF or CSV
- CRAiG (beta): answers questions and summarises your incident data within each user's permissions

## CONFIGURED

Set up by your team to match your plans.

- Response plans, task lists and message templates per incident type
- Groups, sites and audiences to target
- Escalation rules and timings when people do not respond
- Cascading from one channel to the next
- Response options people can choose when they acknowledge

## INTEGRATIONS

Connected to your other systems, where configured.

- Directory sync with Microsoft Entra ID, SCIM or scheduled file import
- Single sign-on with Entra ID, Google Workspace or Okta
- The Microsoft Teams app, enabled by your administrator
- Triggers from monitoring or other systems, set up as an integration project

> Crises Control does not detect incidents on its own. Incidents are raised by people, through SOS, the app or the web, or by connected systems where an integration has been configured. From that point the platform coordinates the response.

USE CASES

# How organisations use Crises Control in transport and logistics

From the first alert to the final record: the incidents this platform is used for, and how the modules work together in each.

### Aviation emergency and crisis team mobilisation

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER Aircraft incident, offshore aviation emergency or other serious operational event

Alert predefined crisis team members, capture acknowledgements and availability, activate response procedures and coordinate role-specific actions.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

### Crew safety and SOS assistance

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER A pilot, flight attendant or other frontline worker requires urgent assistance

Allow the individual to raise an SOS alert, share location where supported and notify the appropriate response personnel.

SOS | Ping | Incident Manager | Control Centre

### Severity assessment and structured incident response

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER An operational event needs initial assessment before a full response is activated

Use an initial notification to assess severity, then launch a structured incident, alert affected users, assign tasks and document actions and evidence.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Media Assets Manager | Audit & Reporting

### Operational service disruption

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER Ferry or other operational service is disrupted, including out of hours

Alert predefined response groups, track acknowledgements, repeat notifications where configured and coordinate recovery actions.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre

### Multi-location and international incident coordination

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER An incident requires response from teams in different countries or operating locations

Mobilise geographically dispersed teams, keep relevant stakeholders informed and maintain a shared record of incident activity.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

### Operational communications resilience

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER Normal communication channels are unavailable, degraded or insufficient

Use independent communication channels to reach internal teams and relevant external contacts, track delivery and acknowledgements, and retain an auditable record.

Ping | Incident Manager | Audit & Reporting | integrations where configured

Customer examples are based on how customers use Crises Control today; customer names have been removed. Customer requirements describe needs raised by customers or in evaluations. Intended, suggested and illustrative use cases show how the platform can be applied and are not presented as existing customer deployments. Capabilities marked 'where configured' or 'where supported' depend on each organisation's set-up.

BUYER'S GUIDE

# Eight questions to ask any incident platform supplier

Many tools can send an alert. These questions separate a notification tool from a platform that coordinates the whole response.

01 **Does it stop at the message?**
Ask what the platform does after the alert is sent: tasks, log, escalation, recovery.

02 **Can it prove who acknowledged?**
Delivery is not acknowledgement. Ask how silence is spotted and escalated, and what you must configure.

03 **Does it run your procedures?**
Ask whether your plans become owned tasks with deadlines, or stay as documents.

04 **Is there one shared picture?**
Ask what leaders see live, and whether it needs someone to update a spreadsheet.

05 **Does it work when your systems do not?**
Ask how teams coordinate if email, chat or your network is down.

06 **Can frontline staff raise the alarm?**
Ask how a colleague on site escalates, with their location where supported, in one action.

07 **What evidence does it leave behind?**
Ask for a sample timeline of the kind a regulator, insurer or inquiry would want.

08 **Can you rehearse in it?**
Ask whether you can run exercises on the same platform you would use for real.

SOURCES

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BOOK YOUR TRANSPORT AND LOGISTICS PLATFORM DEMONSTRATION

# Watch a hub power loss run end to end.

**Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end.** In a live, 30-minute demonstration built around a transport and logistics incident, you will see how our incident management software, an Operational Incident Coordination Platform, takes one incident from first alert to final report. Bring your own scenario.

## WHAT YOU WILL SEE

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | SOS | A depot supervisor reports a power loss, with location where supported. |
| 02 | PING | Drivers, depots and partners are alerted; drivers check in. |
| 03 | INCIDENT MANAGER | The duty manager activates the incident and assigns network roles. |
| 04 | TASK MANAGER | Rerouting, customer updates and welfare checks become owned tasks. |
| 05 | CONTROL CENTRE | Operations sees sites, drivers, vehicles and actions outstanding. |
| 06 | AUDIT & REPORTING | The response record is produced for partners, insurers and regulators. |
| 07 | CRAIG | CRAiG helps the duty manager find information and guidance in the platform. |

**Book your demonstration →**

crises-control.com/incident-management-software-for-transport-and-logistics/

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SCAN TO BOOK

COMPANION REPORT The Heathrow lesson